

ON EARTH AS IT IS IN HEAVEN

TEXT: Matthew 11:9-13 (NKJV) ***“In this manner, therefore, pray: Our Father in heaven, Hallowed be Your name. ¹⁰ Your kingdom come. Your will be done On earth as it is in heaven. ¹¹ Give us this day our daily bread. ¹² And forgive us our debts, As we forgive our debtors. ¹³ And do not lead us into temptation, But deliver us from the evil one. For Yours is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.”***

INTRO: The theme of Empowerment 2019 is *“Kingdom Culture, Bringing Heaven To Earth.”* I want to say this loud and clear; I do not want to be misunderstood. We are not trying to revive the *“Kingdom Now”* theology from the 1960’s and 1970’s. That theology wrongly interpreted much of the Kingdom message of Jesus to say, that we the church would make this earth such a wonderful place that Jesus would eventually leave Heaven to live among us.

Nothing could be further from the truth, and yet as erroneous theology often is, it barely missed a biblical interpretation and veered far from its target into heresy.

Please allow me to begin with a question: “*Why did God choose to save us?*” The religious answer is, “*So He could take us to Heaven.*”

While it is true God wants to eventually take us all to Heaven, I don’t believe that is His intermediate plan. If He saved us just to take us to Heaven would He not have killed us as soon as we accepted Christ? That would be the surest way of getting some of us to Heaven. (Tommy)

I believe He saved us so we could bring Heaven to earth. Once we are saved, our purpose is to bring Heaven to earth:

- In our homes...
- In our personal lives...
- On our jobs...

- At our church... (Stop raising the devil at your church and start bring Heaven to earth at your church)
- In our community...
- In our spheres of influence...

When Heaven comes to earth it changes the atmosphere and changes the culture. The church was never designed to adapt to the culture, it was designed to change and establish culture. The problem is that we as Christians, ministers, and churches, are so intent and focused on going to Heaven that we have failed to bring Heaven to earth. (How many churches do you know that have had no effect on their community?)

I want to look at three levels of Heaven that are supposed to be affected by Christians, ministers and churches. Jesus said, ***“Pray, Your Kingdom come, Your will be done on earth as it is in Heaven.”***

THE FIRST HEAVEN

The First Heaven is the universe we see with our natural eyes:

- I see you ...
- You see me...
- We know we are in Houston...
- We know we are at CT Church...
- We know we are at Empowerment Conference...

We see:

- The sun...
- The moon...
- The stars...
- The creation...

In this realm we pray TO God... ***“Our Father which art in Heaven.”***

If we become too focused on this realm, we cannot affect Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth. This realm is a realm of sight and requires great faith and intense intercession.

Let me ask us, how dedicated are we to establishing Kingdom culture and bringing Heaven to earth? There are some things that only come through “*Fasting and prayer.*” There is a price to be paid for changing culture and bringing Heaven to earth. (Malvern 30 day fast – CT Church 21 day fast)

Here is a news flash: Fasting doesn't get God to do anything that He wouldn't ordinarily do. Fasting kills our flesh and places us in a position of hearing more clearly from God. It also helps us to see what is in the Heavenly realm, and how to bring what is in Heaven to earth.

THE SECOND HEAVEN

The Second Heaven is the dwelling place of the angelic powers, both good and bad.

It is the battle ground where Satan's dark forces are at war with the forces of light and of God.

This is the warfare realm. When you signed up to follow Jesus and especially when you signed on for ministry, you immersed yourself in this realm. As a believer we have the right to operate in this realm and even to command angels.

(Randy Lowe)

(PLAY ANGEL VIDEO)

This is the realm where Daniel's prayers were hindered for 21 day's. (Can you imagine Daniels frustration when he discovered God heard him the first time he prayed?)

In this heavenly realm the problem is not whether God has heard our prayers, it is a matter of the prince of the power of the air disrupting, stalling, and even destroying the answer because we do not know who we are and what authority we have.

In Daniels experience, He continued to contend to bring Heaven to earth for 21 days, and God

finally sent the Arch angel to do the warfare in this realm, in order to get the answer to Daniel.

This realm of the second Heaven requires:

- Patience...
- Persistence...
- Stamina...
- Stick-to-it-ness...

We will not get very far in this realm by blessing our food and a nighty-night-prayer. This realm requires spiritual warfare.

The second Heaven is where intercessors and traffickers in Kingdom culture go to do the necessary warfare to bring Heaven to earth. A prophetic group and intercessors in our church must become a priority if we are going to establish Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth.

THE THIRD HEAVEN

The Third Heaven is God's dwelling place. It is referred to in the Bible as the Highest Heaven, Paradise and the Third Heaven.

The Bible says we are ***“Seated in heavenly places in Christ Jesus.”***

Those who are persistent enough to get to this realm, and become seated in a place of spiritual authority, create Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth.

The writer of Ephesians said that the Father has ***“... Seated Christ at His right hand in the heavenly places, ²¹ far above all principality and power and might and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this age but also in that which is to come.”*** (Ephesians 1:20-23 NKJV) I think we can all agree that Jesus is seated at the right hand of God in a place of great authority and even all authority.

But... The writer begins the very next chapter by saying... ***“God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus.”***

Those who choose to push through to this realm are seated together with Christ and have dominion over:

- Principality and power...
- Might and dominion...
- Every name here and in eternity...

Jesus said, ***“All authority has been given to me in Heaven and in earth... AND I give to you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over ALL the power of the enemy and nothing shall by any means hurt you.”***

When we become seated in this realm:

- We see things from God’s perspective...
- We know things that are not obvious...
- We speak words that change the atmosphere...

- We declare in this realm, what is being spoken in the Heavenly realm...
- We have a helicopter view rather than an earthly view...
- We do things that bring Heaven to earth...

In this realm we begin to pray WITH God, rather than praying TO God.

In this realm we transition from a stereotype to a prototype. In this Heavenly level we are called to be a voice, not an echo!

In this realm all it takes is for one man or one woman to take their rightful place and decide to bring Heaven to earth:

- All our families need, is for us to establish Kingdom culture...
- All our church needs, is for us to begin to establish Kingdom culture...
- All our business needs, is for us to decide to bring Heaven to earth...

- All your city needs, is for us to pay the price to bring Heaven to earth...

The majority rules in the American church but the majority does not rule in Kingdom culture. The Lord does not look down from heaven and take a head count to see who is on the side of a particular issue so He can act. Believe it or not, God is not the cosmic pollster.

Can you imagine Jesus saying to Gabriel, *“Well, Gabe, it looks like we finally got a majority of the people to agree with us on that particular issue, so you can go ahead and intervene on that thing now?”* That is ridiculous, yet it is the predominant mindset of the American Church and quite frankly, it is the very thing that is keeping Heaven from coming to earth.

God continues to say, as He has always said, *“Find Me a man, a woman, a son or a daughter, that will dare to pay the price for bringing*

Heaven to earth, and I will honor My Word and perform signs, miracles and wonders for them.”

God is looking across this room right now for someone who will dare to step out of the ranks of the ordinary and create Kingdom culture. He is looking for someone who is:

- Fed up...
- Fired up...
- And filled up.

CONCLUSION:

God is not looking for a crowd, He is looking for a person.

God is not wowed by the masses, or mesmerized by the multitudes, He just needs someone to step out of the crowd and decide to establish Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth.

God is looking for a person like David to emerge from the wilderness and let the giants of

life know that they have messed with the wrong Kingdom. When we step out of the crowd and become God's Kingdom minded people, we create tipping points where breakthrough is inevitable.

When we become Kingdom minded and decide to create Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth:

- Kingdom people refuse to be identified by political affiliation... (Inside or outside the church – I'm neither Republican nor Democrat, I'm a Kingdom guy! I'm neither red or blue, I'm on the Lords side! I'm not siding with the elephants nor the donkeys, I'm looking to ride a white horse with the one whose vesture has been dipped in blood, and across His thigh is written “***King of Kings and Lord of Lords.***”)
- Kingdom people refuse to be contained by denominational affiliation... (I'm neither Church of Christ, Assembly of God nor Church of God – I'm Kingdom of God!)

- Kingdom people refuse to be confined to a geographical location... (We are determined to see the Glory of God “*Cover the earth as the water covers the sea.*”)
- Kingdom people refuse to be reduced to sexual orientation... (God can use women as well as He can use men – He can use children, just as He can use adults – He used a donkey to speak His word, and I have seen Him do this several times)
- Kingdom people refuse to be confined to ordination... (He can use those who will never have credentials as well as He can use those who have been ordained for forty eleven years – Credentials are for man, not for God – Our credentials are meaningless in the second and third Heaven)

People who establish Kingdom culture and bring Heaven to earth refuse to be condemned to a history lesson, and sift through the ashes of a revival gone by. Rather, they choose to draw a

circle of influence and bring Heaven to earth in that circle.